A FIELD GUIDE FROM PERSEVERANT DIGITAL · FOR HOME IMPROVEMENT

How to Get Roofing, Remodeling and HVAC Leads Without Angi or Shared Lead Sites

Stop paying for leads three other contractors also got. Build a steady flow of homeowners who call you first, show up for the estimate and sign.

THE SHORT ANSWER · 61 WORDS REVIEWED OCTOBER 15, 2026

Build your own lead flow alongside the paid sources. Know the cost per sold job for each source, become the company Google's map and AI assistants name in your towns, make one clear offer, answer every lead within minutes with a person, confirm every estimate, and follow up on quotes that didn't sign. Then keep what pays and cut what doesn't.

You pay for a lead at 8 p.m. By morning the homeowner has heard from two other companies, and one is booked for 9 a.m.

That is the shared-lead treadmill. When the same homeowner reaches several contractors at once, the job often goes to whoever calls first or quotes lowest. Your crews are on roofs and in attics, so the phone goes to voicemail. Some estimates you do book never happen because nobody is home. Others end in a quote that sits in a folder and is never followed up.

You don’t have to quit Angi or Google Local Services Ads tomorrow. Build a flow of homeowners who find you on their own, so paid sources become one choice among several, judged by signed contracts.

What does a sold job cost you from each source?

Start here. Cost per lead tells you almost nothing; a cheap lead that never signs is the most expensive one you buy. Pull the last 90 days from your job tool and invoices.

Source	Spend	Leads	Estimates held	Contracts signed	Revenue	Cost per sold job
Angi or other lead marketplaces						
Google Local Services Ads						
Google search ads						
Google Business Profile (map)						
Facebook or Instagram ads						
Home shows and events						
Referrals, yard signs, repeat customers						

Cost per sold job = spend ÷ contracts signed. Also note close rate: contracts signed ÷ estimates held.

Example numbers, not benchmarks. Source A costs $3,000 for 60 leads, or $50 a lead, and produces 3 signed jobs: $1,000 per sold job. Source B costs $3,000 for 20 leads, or $150 a lead, and produces 6 signed jobs: $500 per sold job. Source B looks expensive per lead and is half the cost per contract.

If you can't fill in "Contracts signed," fix that first. Often the office books by phone and nobody records the source.

- [ ] Add a required "lead source" field in your job tool that nobody can skip
- [ ] Use a separate tracking phone number for each paid source
- [ ] Review this table monthly, by trade if you sell more than one

There is little room for waste. Harvard's Joint Center for Housing Studies projected on April 15, 2026 that owner-occupied improvement and repair spending would grow from $509 billion in Q4 2025 to $518 billion in Q4 2026,

roughly 1.6% to 2.1%. In a slow-growth market, you grow by converting more of what you already pay for.

Why does Google, or ChatGPT, name the other company?

Because they look like the safer choice for that town. Google says local results are based mainly on relevance, distance and prominence, that more reviews and positive ratings can help, and that you can't pay for a better local ranking (Google Business Profile Help).

Homeowners now ask AI assistants, too. BrightLocal's vendor survey, the Local Consumer Review Survey (February 11, 2026, 1,002 US adults), found use of ChatGPT and other AI tools for local recommendations rose from 6% to 45%. The same survey found 97% read reviews for local businesses, 68% require at least 4 stars, and 47% won't use a business with fewer than 20 reviews.

We call this Search Essence Optimization: homeowners search to understand you, not just find you. Your profile, reviews and pages should answer that plainly.

- [ ] Primary category is specific: "Roofing contractor" or "HVAC contractor," not "Contractor"
- [ ] Service area lists only towns your crews actually drive to; address hidden if customers don't visit you
- [ ] Every service you sell is listed, including "free roof inspection" or "furnace replacement estimate"
- [ ] Recent photos of crews, trucks and finished jobs, with the homeowner's permission
- [ ] One page on your site per main service, with honest cost ranges and what drives the price
- [ ] Every review answered in your own words, not a template

On that last point, BrightLocal found 89% of consumers expect owners to respond to reviews, and 50% are put off by templated replies.

Have the project lead ask for a review at the final walkthrough, then send the link that evening. Ask every customer, not only the happy ones. The FTC rule on consumer reviews and testimonials, finalized in August 2024, bans fake reviews (including AI-written ones), buying reviews, rewards conditioned on positive reviews, undisclosed reviews from employees or family, and

suppressing negative reviews (Morgan Lewis, August 26, 2024). This is not legal advice.

What offer gets a homeowner to raise a hand?

A specific, low-pressure first step. “Call for a quote” competes with everyone; a clear offer gives them a reason to pick you.

Trade	Offer	Keep it clean
Roofing	Free roof inspection with photos	No scare claims about damage you haven’t seen; never promise an insurance claim will be approved
Remodeling	Free in-home design and cost walkthrough	Give a realistic range and timeline, not a teaser price
HVAC	Replacement estimate with two or three options	Plain list of what’s included and how long the visit takes
Windows and siding	Free measure and quote	State it’s no obligation and how long it takes
Solar	Total-cost walkthrough	Total cost and financing terms disclosed; no “free solar”

Solar has the strictest rules. The FTC’s business guidance (August 7, 2024) says solar sellers must disclose total cost and financing terms, must not overstate savings or tax credits, and flags “free solar” claims as a scam signal.

Ads that lead with financing may fall under Meta’s credit Special Ad Category, which fixes age targeting at 18 to 65+, restricts ZIP targeting and removes lookalike audiences (Meta Marketing API documentation). This is not legal advice.

Who answers when the crew is on a roof?

Someone other than the crew. An owner on a ladder can’t be the first to call back.

Harvard Business Review (March 2011) found firms that contacted web leads within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify them as firms that waited longer.

Lead arrives	Who gets it first	Backup after 5 minutes	Goal
Phone call, business hours	Office	Owner's cell or answering service	Book the estimate on the call
Web form or marketplace lead	Office, by text and email	Second office person	Call within 5 minutes
After hours or weekend	Answering service or on-call person	Text reply with booking link	Call back first thing
Storm surge	Office plus a second person	Overflow answering service	No lead waits more than an hour

On the call, offer a window, not an open question: "We can come Tuesday between 9 and 11 or Wednesday after 2. Which works?"

Get consent before automatic texts. Under the TCPA, prior express written consent is still required for autodialed or prerecorded marketing calls and texts. Since April 11, 2025, homeowners can revoke consent by any reasonable means, such as replying STOP or QUIT, and you must honor opt-outs within 10 business days (Kelley Drye, January 2025; Burr & Forman). Put clear consent language on every form. This is not legal advice.

How do you stop estimate no-shows?

Confirm every appointment three times, and make it personal. A homeowner who knows who's coming, and when, is more likely to be home.

- [ ] **Right after booking:** text or email with the date, arrival window, estimator's name and photo
- [ ] **Day before:** a short reminder with an easy way to reschedule
- [ ] **Two hours before:** "Mike is on his way, arriving between 9 and 10"
- [ ] **If nobody's home:** call from the driveway, then text a link to rebook the same day
- [ ] **Track it:** no-show rate = estimates missed ÷ estimates booked, by source

A high no-show rate from one source can mean those homeowners were shopping several companies at once.

What happens to the estimates that didn’t sign?

Often nothing. Some homeowners aren’t saying no; they’re waiting on a spouse, insurance, a second quote or the next season.

When	What to send	Who sends it
Same day	Thank-you, written quote, one line on what happens next	Estimator
Day 2 or 3	Call: “Any questions on the quote?”	Estimator or office
Day 7	Answer a common concern: warranty, timeline, financing terms	Office
Day 14	Call to ask if the project is still on	Estimator
Day 30	Check-in; offer to update the quote	Office
Each season	A useful note before storm, heating or cooling season	Office

Mark each quote won, lost (and why) or open. Keep solar follow-up factual, and stop texting anyone who opts out.

Where do most owners get stuck?

> **The source never reaches the contract.** Phone-booked estimates skip the source field. Fixing it means changing how the office books and connecting tracking numbers, forms and marketplaces to the job tool.

> **Nobody owns the phone during a storm.** Routing that works on a normal Tuesday breaks when volume triples. Overflow rules and after-hours coverage are easy to put off until the week you need them.

> **Proof goes stale.** Map rankings and AI answers lean on reviews, current photos and honest town pages. Keeping that up in a busy season is a habit that’s easy to drop.

If you want a second set of eyes on your numbers, book a 25-minute exploration call with the short form at the end of this guide.

Sources

- Harvard Joint Center for Housing Studies, “Remodeling growth set to downshift in late 2026,” April 15, 2026. link
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- Harvard Business Review, “The Short Life of Online Sales Leads,” March 2011. link
- Kelley Drye, “Eleventh Circuit vacates TCPA one-to-one consent rule,” January 2025. link
- Burr & Forman, “The FCC delays effective date of TCPA revoke-all rule until January 31, 2027,” 2025. link

Want a second set of eyes on your plan?

Book a free 25-minute exploration call. We will look at your numbers with you, name the first fixes in order, and tell you honestly if we are not the right fit.

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